

EYEWITNESS August 30, 1862

Longstreet's Flank Attack at Second Bull Run

On the first two days of battle, Stonewall Jackson's corps bore the brunt of the fighting. James Longstreet arrived with his corps to support Jackson's right flank, but he waited until the afternoon of the third day to launch a counterattack. This was immediately effective. Union commander John Pope had completely misread Longstreet's intentions and was forced to order a retreat.

"A fair opportunity was offered me, and the intended diversion was changed into an attack. My whole line was rushed forward at a charge. The troops sprang to their work, and moved forward with all the steadiness and firmness that characterizes warworn veterans. The batteries, continuing their play upon the confused masses, completed the rout of this portion of the enemy's line, and my attack was therefore made against the forces in my front ... The attacking columns moved steadily forward, driving the enemy from his different positions as rapidly as he took them ... The battle continued until 10 o'clock at night, when utter darkness put a stop to our progress. The enemy made his escape across Bull Run before daylight."

LIEUTENANT GENERAL JAMES LONGSTREET, IN HIS REPORT OF OCTOBER 10, 1862, FROM *OFFICIAL RECORDS OF THE WAR OF THE REBELLION*

"We were near enough to see some wavering in the blue masses, then halt, and then a flight back to cover. But it was all up with John Pope. No rest was given his army. Longstreet started every man of us to his division to push them into attack, and soon everything was hotly engaged. The easy, rounded ridges ran at right angles to the turnpike, and over these infantry and artillery poured in pursuit. The artillery would gallop furiously to the nearest ridge, limber to the front, deliver a few rounds until the enemy were out of range, and then gallop again to the next ridge. And thus it went on until black darkness stopped operations ...